



History of Amiga

Amiga was a pretty famous computer back in the '90s, but do you know about its history? <http://dgit.in/Amigaprt9>



Respite for Skylake

Microsoft has graciously extended Skylake support for Windows 7 and 8.1 until the next year. <http://dgit.in/Skylake10>

Industry Connect

Rethinking open source for mobile



While Apple, Microsoft and Google are aggressively focusing on all things mobile, what are open source companies up to? We sat down with Mr. Amarjeet Manchanda, Director, Consulting Services, Red Hat, to discuss how open source needs to adapt to the mobile market's opportunities and challenges.



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What is Red Hat's take on open source in mobile?

Mobility today needs a lot of lightweight applications. If the app itself is 120 MB or half a gigabyte, you may not want to download it. Lightweight apps that are agile, slim and lean, and a similar back-end infrastructure is what is going to make this whole concept of mobility for the enterprises.

Everyone wants mobility, thanks to its convenience. User experience demands lot of new services and in the future, I'm sure there'll be cut-throat competition between similar service providers to bring in new features as quickly as possible. All these things again lead to lightweight and agile infrastructure at the backend, which is exactly where Red Hat comes into play.

I understand that PAAS is already working in various consumer facing services. Could you explain some of these avenues where it is being used?

PAAS is critical in mobility, because of reasons I just mentioned. That being said, there are a lot of infrastructure companies, railways, airlines, etc., and we're working with a lot of prospects as well, whose names we can't share right now. There are some large airports in Europe

that are using such services. For example, if your close relative is travelling, the person will be carrying a mobile platform and you can track their journey.

Android has been open source always, but being open source has brought fragmentation. Do you think there's any way for open source to get around this?

Well, if you look at the upside of this. The fragmentation is actually taking it wider and deeper. Yes, the fragmentation is there, but perhaps unification will help.

From a PC perspective, open source has been very important, but is the demand declining now?

PC has been seeing a decline with or without open source for a while now. I think it's a natural evolution. Will the mobile phone do everything that a PC does today? No. But in the future, maybe yes. Maybe the two platforms will converge. PC has its own space in the market, has its own plus points over the mobile platforms, and those will remain for some time, but I do see a convergence between the platforms in future.

Is the demand increasing for backend infrastructure for apps instead of software?

Absolutely. There are three things that are driving the adoption of apps. One is services on the mobile being provided

by some of the market leaders. This is driving the demand on the backend infrastructure, which is further helping and enabling the adoption of open source for us and others in the community.

This is also bringing a difference to the end-user experience. The widely available application set, key applications, right from booking movie tickets, to selling something, or government portals, are all together driving the demand for MBAAS (Mobile Backend As A Service). For Red Hat, that means RHMAP (Red Hat Mobile Application Platform).

There was a time when open source had to really fight against proprietary systems. Do you think a similar thing will happen again with mobile or is open source established enough now that there's really no competition?

Well, see, open source has come a long way. From being considered an amateur operating system, if I could use the word (maybe a few years ago) it has come to be enterprise class, running mission critical operations, from banks to exchanges. So, will the challenges we once faced still prevail with the advent of mobility, I don't think so. All the future technology advancements will be closer in the vicinity of open source. In fact, some of our competition is also going to be giving a part of their services as open source.